IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 6, 2026

Convergence

March payrolls surprise at +178K, a 45-day ceasefire framework is on the table, and Trump sets a new Tuesday deadline — three catalysts collide on a single Monday morning.

S&P 500 (THU)	BRENT CRUDE	NFP (GOOD FRI)	GOLD	FEAR & GREED
6,583 ↑0.38%	~$109 · Flat	+178K vs 60K est	~$4,720 · Flat	13 · Extreme Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

THE TRIPLE CATALYST ARRIVES — MARKETS PROCESS ALL THREE SIMULTANEOUSLY

This is the Monday that prior briefs identified as the convergence point. Three catalysts that were expected to arrive independently are now hitting the tape at once. First, March nonfarm payrolls surprised sharply to the upside at +178,000 versus the 60,000 consensus, released Friday morning while markets were closed for Good Friday. Second, Egyptian, Pakistani, and Turkish mediators have presented a 45-day ceasefire proposal to both Washington and Tehran, though Iran has rejected the temporary framework. Third, Trump set a new Tuesday, 8 PM ET deadline threatening power plants and bridges if the Strait of Hormuz is not reopened. Thursday's close—the last tradable session—was subdued: S&P +0.38%, Dow +0.27%, Nasdaq +0.61%, with crypto leading (IBIT +3.92%, ETHA +4.41%, COIN +3.23%) and energy lagging (VLO –1.10%, CAT –0.83%). Monday premarket is fractionally positive, with S&P futures edging up approximately 0.12% as the market weighs the NFP beat against the deadline uncertainty.

NFP +178K REMOVES THE LAST RATE CUT ARGUMENT

The March jobs report exceeded expectations by a factor of three. Healthcare added 76,000 positions, largely reflecting the Kaiser Permanente strike resolution that depressed February's data. Construction contributed 26,000, transportation added 21,000, and manufacturing gained 15,000. The unemployment rate edged down to 4.3%. February's data was revised per the BLS release, putting the three-month average at approximately 68,000. The headline is unambiguously strong—but it arrives in an environment where the Fed is already constrained. ISM Prices at 78.3, the OECD's 4.2% US inflation forecast, and the upcoming Warsh confirmation hearing next week collectively eliminate the case for any rate relief in 2026. The NFP beat confirms that the labor market is not in crisis, which removes the employment side of the dual mandate from supporting a cut. For

IOWN, this is constructive for the dividend sleeve (ADP, FAST, SYK)—strong employment supports consumer demand—but tightens the vise on rate-sensitive names (NEE, BKH, ATO) that needed softer data to justify a dovish pivot.

THURSDAY'S SESSION: CRYPTO LED, ENERGY LAGGED, GOLD STABILIZED

Thursday's session was the most sectionally balanced of the conflict. Financials (+0.85%), staples (+0.64%), and real estate (+0.58%) led—a defensive-value tilt. Energy (–0.14%) and materials (–0.58%) were the only sectors in the red. The digital asset sleeve posted its strongest session of the week: ETHA +4.41%, MARA +4.02%, IBIT +3.92%, COIN +3.23%. Charles Schwab announced plans to launch direct crypto trading, according to Yahoo Finance—a structural positive for digital asset adoption. Gold stabilized at GLD $429.94 (+0.12%) after Wednesday's 2.7% selloff on the Warsh confirmation news. AEM gained 0.42% while GFI declined 1.35%. Oil was essentially flat (BNO –0.09%), consolidating near $109. The net picture: the market was waiting for today. Now it is here.

MARCH NFP	**+178,000 · 3x consensus · Unemployment 4.3%**
S&P 500	**6,583 Thu · Futures +0.12% Mon AM**
BRENT CRUDE	**~$109 · Israel struck Asaluyeh petrochemical Mon**
FED OUTLOOK	**Zero cuts priced for 2026 · Warsh hearing week of Apr 13**
CEASEFIRE PROPOSAL	**45-day framework on table · Iran rejected temporary terms**
TRUMP DEADLINE	**Tuesday 8 PM ET · Power plants + bridges**

Three catalysts, one morning. The NFP beat is the signal that persists regardless of the geopolitical outcome: the labor market is not in crisis, the Fed is not cutting, and the portfolio's cash-generative holdings are performing in the environment they were designed for. The ceasefire proposal and the deadline will dominate the next 36 hours. The employment data will define the next 36 weeks. Think Like an Owner.

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

THE 45-DAY CEASEFIRE PROPOSAL — FRAMEWORK WITHOUT CONSENSUS

Egyptian, Pakistani, and Turkish mediators have presented a draft proposal calling for a 45-day ceasefire and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, according to Axios. Both Washington and Tehran have received the framework. The 45-day window would provide time for negotiations toward a permanent cessation of hostilities. However, Iran rejected the temporary ceasefire concept, stating that a pause would allow adversaries to regroup and continue the conflict, according to CNN. Tehran's position remains unchanged: the Strait stays closed until Iran receives full compensation for war damages and guarantees against future attacks. The mediators are working on confidence-building measures around Hormuz transit and Iran's enriched uranium stockpile, which remain Tehran's primary negotiating leverage. The Iran-Oman monitoring protocol announced Thursday represents the most concrete step toward partial Hormuz reopening, but it falls well short of the full restoration that Trump is demanding.

ISRAEL STRIKES ASALUYEH — 50% OF IRAN'S PETROCHEMICAL CAPACITY HIT

Israel carried out a strike on Asaluyeh, Iran's largest petrochemical facility, which accounts for approximately 50% of the country's petrochemical production, according to Reuters. The defense minister confirmed the operation. Separately, the intelligence head of Iran's Revolutionary Guards was killed in a separate strike, according to media reports. The strikes came as Trump set a new deadline: Tuesday at 8 PM ET for Hormuz reopening, with power plants and bridges as potential targets. The Asaluyeh strike represents a significant escalation in targeting Iranian economic infrastructure—moving beyond military and nuclear targets to the industrial base that generates export revenue. For energy markets, the destruction of petrochemical capacity could extend the period of elevated regional supply disruption even in a ceasefire scenario, as rebuilding takes years. Brent is trading near $109 on Monday morning.

Day 37 — Diplomacy and Escalation Running in Parallel

The same weekend that produced the 45-day ceasefire proposal also saw continued strikes on Tehran, the killing of a senior IRGC intelligence official, and the Asaluyeh petrochemical attack. Loaded Qatar LNG vessels retreated after approaching the Strait of Hormuz, according to Reuters ship-tracking data. JPMorgan's Jamie Dimon warned that the Iran war may drive inflation and interest rates higher. The Kremlin described the entire Middle East as being "on fire." The diplomatic track and military track continue to produce contradictory signals on the same day. For IOWN, the convergence of these forces on a single Monday creates the highest single-session event risk since the conflict began. The portfolio's construction—energy for sustained disruption, defense for escalation, dividend names for cash generation through uncertainty, and gold for the inflation overhang—was designed for exactly this kind of compressed catalyst window.

45-Day CeasefireProposal delivered to both sides · Iran rejected temporary terms

AsaluyehIsrael struck Iran's largest petrochemical facility · 50% of capacity

IRGCIntelligence head killed in separate strike

Tuesday Deadline8 PM ET · Power plants + bridges if Hormuz not opened

Qatar LNGLoaded vessels retreated from Hormuz approach

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Tuesday's 8 PM ET deadline is the immediate binary event. Trump has threatened to strike Iranian power plants and bridges if the Strait of Hormuz is not fully reopened. The 45-day ceasefire proposal is on the table but Iran has rejected temporary terms. If the deadline passes without action, markets may interpret it as another extension (this would be the third). If strikes materialize, oil could gap sharply higher and the ceasefire framework collapses. The portfolio is positioned through the range of outcomes. Avoid Erosion—discipline through deadlines, not around them.

2. The NFP +178K print cements a zero-cut Fed through 2026. With ISM Prices at 78.3, OECD US inflation at 4.2%, and March employment surprising to the upside, the case for monetary easing has evaporated. The Warsh Fed Chair confirmation hearing, now scheduled for the April 16, adds hawkish expectations. Rate-sensitive holdings (NEE, BKH, ATO) face a structurally different policy environment than the one that prevailed before the war. ADP (+0.61% Thursday) and SYK (+0.79%) demonstrate the dividend sleeve's resilience in a no-cut world. Research Reveals Opportunities.

3. Israel's strike on Asaluyeh introduces long-duration supply risk. Petrochemical facilities take years to rebuild. Even if a ceasefire framework emerges this week, the destruction of 50% of Iran's petrochemical capacity creates a structural supply deficit in the global chemicals and refined products market that persists well beyond the conflict. This is constructive for IOWN's energy sleeve (CVX, VLO, OKE) on a multi-quarter horizon, independent of the near-term geopolitical resolution. **The physical world matters.**

4. Schwab launching direct crypto trading is the latest structural adoption signal. Combined with Morgan Stanley's MSBT Bitcoin ETF (NYSE listing received last week), the institutional on-ramps for digital assets continue to multiply. IBIT (+3.92%), ETHA (+4.41%), COIN (+3.23%), and HUT (+3.22%) all gained Thursday as the digital sleeve showed renewed strength. The near-term price action remains tied to geopolitical risk, but the medium-term adoption trajectory is unambiguously constructive. Think Like an Owner.

5. Week ahead: Warsh hearing, CPI nowcast, and Q1 earnings season approaches. The Senate Banking Committee hearing for Kevin Warsh as Fed Chair is expected the April 16. Early April CPI nowcasts have surged to 3.71%, up from 3.25% in March, per the prior brief. Q1 earnings season begins mid-month. For IOWN, the near-term focus is the Tuesday deadline and the ceasefire framework; the medium-term focus shifts to how the war's inflationary impact flows through corporate earnings. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

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